

The flute is also a unique instrument in the sense that unlike a guitar where you can move from a G-sharp to an A-sharp by tightening some strings, in a flute each individual instrument can only play one scale. “The thickness and length of the flute varies depending upon the scale,” explains Krishna. He plays the G-sharp normally but also has flutes for C-sharp and A-sharp.

Besides the flute, Krishna also likes to dabble in photography. He earlier clicked black and white pictures and portraits but now likes to do macro photography. He uses a Canon EOS RP. “Because I am short on time, macro photography works. It can be done anywhere; just sit in a room and do some creative stuff,” he smiles. “To develop any passion one needs to devote at least eight

“It’s a funny story about why I started playing the flute. My name, Vamsi, means flute in Telugu. Subconsciously it was always there that maybe I should learn to play the flute”

to nine hours a week, and currently it is difficult to come by,” says the CEO whose biggest passion is teaching. “The thing that energises me the most is teaching. Before starting Vedantu, my founders and I used to take offline classes, and whenever I entered a classroom, it was very meditative. I miss not being able to teach as much now,” he says.

Krishna believes it is important to keep mentally fit as well. He often plays chess or poker.

So, what’s next for Vedantu? “We are working towards an IPO,” says Krishna. “We are looking at a two-three year time frame.” **BT**

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RIDE ON Sharma prefers touring bikes as they’re meant for long-distance travel

THE WIND IN HER HAIR

Ambika Sharma, Founder and MD of Pulp Strategy, loves touring the country on her bike

BY SMITA TRIPATHI

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For 43-year-old Ambika Sharma, the Founder and MD of Pulp Strategy, a digital communications and marketing agency, her love for biking started when she was just 12 years old. Her father, a retired army officer, loved his Royal Enfield and inculcated that love in his young daughter. She got her first bike—another Royal Enfield—when she was in college in Delhi in the late 1990s. At that time, not too many women rode bikes. The BBC programme *Wheels* wanted someone to test ride their bikes and Sharma got that as a freelance gig. “That got me an opportunity to ride every two-wheeler that was coming into the market, adding to my love for bikes,” says Sharma. She retained her trusted Royal Enfield right through college and work, and when she was finally able to afford it, she moved to a Honda 600cc Super Sport in 2007. In 2010, she moved to a Honda 1000cc.

Having tried her hand at sports bikes, she moved to a Harley-Davidson Road King in 2013. “I wanted to go on this long tour with my dad. He was riding pillion and I wanted the right touring bike,” says Sharma. They did an 18-day

trip of the coastline of India, from Delhi to Kanyakumari and back. “The plan was to eat fish at every village on the coastline,” smiles Sharma. The plan came about impromptu when Sharma’s father complained that there wasn’t good fish in Delhi. Post the trip, Sharma’s father bought his own bike—a Harley-Davidson SuperLow—and now for nearly eight years the father-daughter duo has been biking all over the country. “We have a list of the places we travelled to when I was a kid and we want to visit those places again,” says Sharma. They have ridden over 150,000 km across the country. They explore one state every year. They have already done trips to Gujarat, Nagaland, Odisha, J&K and Ladakh, among others. On the cards, is the North-East that they want to explore in detail.

Sharma’s other bike is a BMW GTL, also meant for touring. She prefers touring bikes as they are meant for long-distance travel. “You need to carry all your stuff with you, so the bike has to provide for that.” **BT**

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